

US-Iran Conflict Briefing

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U.S. pressure strands Iranian tankers off Sri Lanka

- About twenty empty Iranian oil tankers are stranded roughly fifteen miles off Sri Lanka's southwest coast, engines idled, running low on food, fuel, and fresh water. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- U.S. officials in recent weeks pressed Colombo, through the American embassy, to block local firms from provisioning the vessels, citing secondary-sanctions risk. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The report cites Sri Lankan government documents and shipping-company sources, and quotes a Kpler analyst saying all revenue from the trade could drop to zero for Iran by December. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- Dozens of Iranian or Iran-linked tankers have been stuck near Sri Lanka and Malaysia since the Hormuz blockade was reimposed in July, and the advocacy group UANI says the remaining Iranian oil awaiting transfer runs out in the coming weeks. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

Sept 29 Hormuz tankers identified

- The three tankers struck in the Strait of Hormuz on Tuesday, September 29, are now identified: the Liberian-flagged oil-products tanker Al Ruwais, the very large crude carrier Mersin Prosperity, and the Aframax-sized Sinbad — all transiting with their AIS transponders switched off. — [Reuters](#)
- Maritime intelligence firm Marisks says all three were hit by unknown projectiles; Kpler data shows Al Ruwais conducted a ship-to-ship transfer off Sohar, Oman, in late September to discharge its diesel cargo. — [Reuters](#)
- Mersin Prosperity moved about two million barrels of Iraqi Basrah crude in a mid-September ship-to-ship transfer off Sohar, while Sinbad loaded refined products at Saudi Arabia's Jubail port in early September, per Kpler data cited by Reuters. — [Reuters](#)
- ADNOC Logistics and Services, which manages Al Ruwais and Mersin Prosperity, declined to comment; Sinbad is managed by Anglo-Eastern Tanker Management. — [Reuters](#)

Markets

- Brent crude traded at \$99.85 a barrel on October 1, near-flat in early Asia trade as investors assessed stalled U.S.-Iran talks and recovering Gulf exports. — [Reuters](#)
- WTI traded at \$91.47 a barrel on October 1, gaining about a dollar on Wednesday with support near \$88. — [Reuters](#)
- UK NBP day-ahead gas priced at 180.58 pence per therm for September 30, rising on fears of prolonged LNG disruption. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

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Tankers transiting the Strait of Hormuz (file photo) — [view original](#)

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